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MEDIA & EVENTS

Ray Varner Ford Used Cars — September 2026 Digital Advertising Summary

Reporting period: September 1 – September 30, 2026

Trade-In Season Arrives

September is when the pre-owned side of a dealership tends to fill back up. The model-year changeover brings a wave of trade-ins onto the lot, and shoppers who weren't ready for a new-vehicle price start comparing late-model used options instead. This site kept its upward run going through that shift: a fifth consecutive month of growth, with gains across visitors, vehicle views and ad response.

September by the Numbers

- Vehicle detail page views: **625** site-wide (up 7.6%) and **319** from ad visitors (up 4.9%)
- Site visitors: **1,272** across **1,536** sessions (both up between 5% and 6%)
- Visitors who came from the ads: **795** (up 5.3%)
- Page views: **3,722** (up 6.3%)
- Search click-through rate: **10.58%** on 7,911 impressions and 837 clicks
- Display click-through rate: **1.23%**, up for a fourth straight month
- Average time on site: **2 minutes 39 seconds**

More Shoppers Looking at Specific Vehicles

Vehicle detail page views reached 625 site-wide, up 7.6% from August, and 319 of them came from people who arrived through the ads. A detail page view is the most meaningful signal on a used-car site: it means a shopper stopped on one particular vehicle to study the photos, mileage and price rather than just scrolling the lot.

The rest of the site moved with it. Visitors rose 5.6%, page views 6.3%, and the engagement rate edged up to 61.33%. People also stayed a little longer, averaging 2 minutes 39 seconds. The inventory page remained the main destination, drawing 1,028 of the month's 1,272 visitors.

Search and Display Both Gained

Search impressions grew 4.8% and clicks grew 5.0%, holding the click-through rate at 10.58%. Ads continued to appear in the top three positions about two-thirds of the time. By ad group:

- **General Used Cars**: 3,788 impressions, 479 clicks, a 12.65% click-through rate
- **General Used Trucks**: 2,688 impressions, 230 clicks, 8.56%
- **General Used SUVs**: 1,435 impressions, 128 clicks, 8.92%

SUVs were the standout, with clicks up 13% and the click-through rate rising from 8.48% to 8.92%. That fits the season: families shopping for more room ahead of the holidays and winter driving.

Display extended its winning streak to a fourth month. The ads were shown 17,041 times and drew 209 clicks, lifting the click-through rate to 1.23%, up from 1.18% in August and 1.1% in June. Think of display as a digital billboard for people already in the market for a pre-owned vehicle; it is steadily earning more response for the same exposure.

Smaller Towns, Stronger Response

Oak Ridge again delivered the most volume, with 12,212 impressions and 268 clicks. The surrounding communities continue to respond at far higher rates:

- **Huntsville**: 208 impressions, 31 clicks, a **14.9%** click-through rate
- **Sunbright**: 411 impressions, 49 clicks, **11.92%**
- **Oliver Springs**: 2,036 impressions, 239 clicks, **11.74%**
- **Wartburg**: 1,610 impressions, 185 clicks, **11.49%**

Oliver Springs produced nearly as many clicks as Oak Ridge from about one-sixth of the impressions. Where buyers have fewer nearby lots to choose from, an ad for local pre-owned inventory simply lands harder.

The Audience

The shopper profile held steady: 58.5% men and 41.5% women, with those 65 and older the largest group at 32.2% and the 55-64 bracket next at 23.3%. More than half of ad exposure reaches buyers

55 and up, a pattern that has now held all summer.

Phones did most of the work. Mobile ads drew 818 clicks at a 6.16% click-through rate, up from 5.99% in August, compared with 2.98% on desktop and 1.31% on tablets.

Heading Into Fall

Five straight months of measured growth, with every main measure up again in September. Trade-in volume typically stays healthy through the fall, which gives the site fresh inventory to put in front of shoppers. The rural communities remain the clearest opportunity: they respond at several times the rate of the larger markets, and there is room to lean further into them as the season continues.
